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Author(s): Brent Vine
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Notes on the Corcolle Altar Fragments (CIL I² (4) 2833 a)

By Brent Vine, Princeton

1. Several fragments of an altar came to light in Corcolle (near Tivoli) in 1975, with an archaic Latin inscription containing about 60 legible characters, first published in 1978.[1]) These fragments can be dated to about 500 B. C.: approximately the same era as the far better-known (although shorter) "Lapis Satricanus" (CIL I² (4) 2832 a). While the Satrican inscription set off a storm of publications that continues unabated after more than ten years, the Corcolle altar fragments have gone almost entirely unstudied since Prosdocimi's 1979 article-length description and discussion.[2])

Several obvious factors help account for this neglect. Although the Corcolle altar preserves more legible characters than the Lapis Satricanus, no single complete word can be read with absolute certainty, in contrast with the four clear words **Popliosio, Valesiosio, suodales** and **Mamartei.** Moreover, the Lapis Satricanus preserves several striking items with evident linguistic interest (such as the genitives in **-osio,** or the spelling of *suodales* with **-u-**), while the Corcolle fragments seem to offer rather slim pickings, beyond the peculiar (and, as always, incomplete) form **muliar[.** Nevertheless, the corpus of 6th- and 5th-century Latin inscriptions remains pitifully small, and any scraps of knowledge we can glean from them become correspondingly precious. Prosdocimi's preliminary treatment of these fragments was remarkably rich and full, considering the unpromising nature of the material. But there is room for further discussion of some points, which may eventually shed light on a variety of early Latin paleographical and linguistic problems.

The scholarly bibliography for the Corcolle fragments is not large. The initial publication by Morandi (with inaccurate and incomplete transcription, and very little commentary) was superseded by Prosdocimi's detailed study (see footnotes 1 and 2), and the fragments now appear (with facsimiles and commentary) in the 1986

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[1]) A. Morandi, in *Archeologia laziale* 1 (Rome 1978) 89–91 (with photos, tab. 33).

[2]) L. Prosdocimi, *SE* 47 (1979) 197–216 (including facsimiles; photos: tab. 49–51). Photos 50 b and 50 c are mislabeled (their order is reversed), as is 1 a, which represents frag. C, not B.

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supplement to CIL I².[3]) Unfortunately, with a handful of exceptions, the CIL annotations merely reproduce Prosdocimi's findings and conjectures, and add nothing new to the discussion. In the "editio princeps" of the Satrican inscription, Colonna briefly compared its letter-forms with those of the Corcolle fragments (in many ways very similar), in an attempt to establish the approximate date of these more or less contemporary inscriptions.[4]) Most recently, Wachter has provided a transcription, together with several brief remarks, in his recent study of Archaic Latin inscriptions.[5])

The following transcription of the three fragments ("A", "B" and "C") is essentially that of Prosdocimi (followed in CIL, with an important exception to be noted below):[6])

	A	B	C
		uo̯[	
1	**]i:popl[**	**]:u̯oo̯oi?[**	**]i̯--se [?**
2	**]-:iouos-[**	**]-od:oṛaṭ[**	**]os:[mu̯]li[**
3	**]os:fra[**	**]m:muliar[**	**]d:a[–]i̯o[**
4	**]os:uid[**	**]ioṵeiai̯:ne[**	**]ṭod**

2. Before taking up individual forms, I wish to comment briefly on the paleography of these fragments, the nature and interest of which have been misrepresented in Wachter's recent treatment.

According to Wachter (following Colonna), the only paleographical fact of any interest is that the archaic "P" (= R, but without the "new" diagonal stroke) appears side by side with the more modern four-stroke M (as opposed to the older five-stroke version); the same collocation appears in the Lapis Satricanus, which Wachter takes to be the inscription paleographically most similar to the Corcolle fragments (apart from certain gross but fundamentally less significant differences, such as the relative neatness of the Satrican inscription vs. the sloppy appearance of the Corcolle characters, or the different styles of word-division). But there are several other features that

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[3]) *Corpus Inscriptionum Latinarum* I², fasc. 4 (Berlin 1986), ed. A. Degrassi, J. Krummrey; no. 2833 a (pp. 858–9).

[4]) G. Colonna, in C. M. Stibbe et al., *Lapis Satricanus* (The Hague 1980) 45–8.

[5]) R. Wachter, *Altlateinische Inschriften* (Bern/Frankfurt am Main/New York/Paris 1987) § 37 (pp. 93–4). See also the "Korrekturnachtrag".

[6]) Some deficiencies in Wachter's transcription will also be noted at various points below.

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render the paleographical profile of the Corcolle fragments more complex and interesting than Wachter makes out.

Two important facts (not mentioned by Wachter) had already been discussed at some length by Prosdocimi (200), namely the upside-down form of the first V of B 1 **]:ụoụoi?[** (Λ), and the probable upside-down L (ᒣ) in C 3. Precisely these two features are found, moreover, in the somewhat earlier Tibur pedestal inscription (CIL I² 2658): Λ = V (**kauios**) and ᒣ = L (**fileod**, written right-to-left, but otherwise identical to the left-to-right ᒣ of Corcolle C 3). Thus the correspondence of these two unusual letter-forms in virtually the same area at much the same time may well point to a close paleographical connection between the Corcolle fragments and the Tibur pedestal – a connection surely as significant as the R/M parallel with the Lapis Satricanus noted by Colonna and Wachter. Wachter's observation (in his discussion of the Tibur pedestal, *AI* § 31 b) that "Die auffälligen kopfstehenden Buchstabenformen, nämlich das L... und das V..., die beide in der Gegend von Latium sonst nicht bezeugt sind, ..." is therefore incorrect. Indeed, the probable recurrence of both letter-forms in the Corcolle inscription undermines Wachter's essentially ad hoc explanation for their appearance in the Tibur pedestal.[7])

Several additional paleographical points will emerge in connection with the restoration of C 1 proposed in § 6 below.

3. As for the relationship of the fragments to one another, and their general purport: Prosdocimi has argued convincingly for the order B + C, given the large space at the end of C 4 (apparently the absolute end of the inscription), together with the negative **ne[** at the end of B 4, preceding the final imperative **]ṭod** of C 4. These, together with B 3 **muliar[**, would seem to suggest a sacral prohibition along the lines of the famous injunction *Pelex aram Iunonis ne tangito* (P. F. 248.5 L, cf. Gell. 4.3.3 (*Paelex; aedem*); see Palmer *RRRE* 35 ff. for discussion). But the position of fragment A is less clear (cf. Prosdocimi's diagrams, p. 207): although it seems to precede B and C, it remains uncertain whether it precedes them *directly,* a point to which I return below (§ 7).

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[7]) For the Corcolle fragments, Morandi (n. 1 above) observes (p. 90): "sembra che ci siano lettere rovesciate forse per un lontano influsso della scrittura bustrofedica"; such a background is still clearer in the partly-serpentine Tibur pedestal, and the problem deserves further investigation in this light.

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4. B 1 **]:u̯ou̯o:?[.**[8]) The query after the second word-divider (as in the transcriptions by Prosdocimi and in CIL) points to a serious indeterminacy neither indicated in Wachter's transcription nor mentioned in his commentary: according to Prosdocimi, who has viewed the stone himself, the extent and nature of the deterioration make it unclear whether the two marks here represent a word-divider (which is what they appear to be in the photographs) or chance abrasions. But Prosdocimi's profession of uncertainty may be somewhat overstated, perhaps motivated in part by the problem of explaining the admittedly difficult form **:u̯ou̯o:** as a single word. Thus Prosdocimi's conjecture **u̯ou̯o[tom** 'votum' virtually entails the assumption that there is no word-divider, since his alternative suggestion of an abbreviation **u̯ou̯o:[** for **u̯ou̯o(tom):[** must be considered only a remote possibility, such an abbreviation in this period (and in such an inscription) being exceedingly unlikely.[9]) Moreover, Prosdocimi's preform **u̯ogᵘheto-*, although morphologically possible, will not produce Lat. *vōtum* directly;[10]) nor does U. **vufetes** (II a 31, IV 25), despite Prosdocimi, support his analysis, since the word's etymology is uncertain (cf. Poultney *BT* 184 f., Meiser *Umbr.* 156).

There are other possibilities that deserve consideration, one of which Prosdocimi explicitly rejects: he asserts (214) that an *o*-stem substantive **u̯ou̯o-* (< **u̯ogᵘho-*) is excluded, on the grounds that such a form is otherwise unknown (apart from the imperfect parallel Gk. *εὐχή*). But Ved. *vāghát-* 'sacrificer' (almost certainly < **u̯ogᵘho-t-*, cf. *sravát-* 'stream' : *srávati* 'flows') presupposes just such a formation (although there is no other evidence for the existence of such a form in Latin).

It may be more promising to explore whether **]:u̯ou̯o:?[** can represent a finite form of *voveō*. In view of the plain thematic present

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[8]) Wachter erroneously transcribes **]i:u̯ou̯o:[**, perhaps after Prosdocimi's transcription **]i:u̯ou̯o:?[** (208, clearly a typographical error for **]:u̯ou̯o:?[**, correctly transcribed on p. 204, and evident from the facsimiles on p. 203).

[9]) The same point applies to Prosdocimi's suggestion that A 1 **popl[** might also be an abbreviation, although here the issue is complicated by what appears to be a (single) dot after the **-l**. (This and several other minor problems not treated here are discussed in the commentary to this inscription in my forthcoming handbook of Archaic Latin inscriptions.)

[10]) For the phonological problem with the treatment of **-ou̯e-/*-ou̯i-* (and probably also **-ou̯o-*) see e. g. Leumann *LLuF* 133 f., Radke *AL* 33 ff., Parker *Rel. Chronol.* 198 ff.; *vōtum* is most likely an analogical replacement for **vūtum* (see Parker 203–4, 206–8).

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*(h_1)*eug*$^{(u)}$*h-e/o-* attested in Gk. (*εὔχομαι*), Lat. *voveō* – although usually taken at face value as an iterative **u̯og^{u}h-éi̯e/o-* – might in theory replace a thematic *u̯eg^{u}h-e/o-*, as in *misceō* for thematic **miĝ/ǩ-ske/o-*,[11]) Class. Lat. *fulgeō* vs. OLat. *fulgō* (cf. Gk. *φλέγω*, Toch. B. *pälketär*), etc.[12]) In this case, a thematic **u̯oi̯o:?[** could represent either a 3 pl. **u̯oi̯o[nt** (without word-divider), presumably impersonal (cf. XII Tab. I. 6 *Rem ubi pacunt, orato*), or a 1 sg. **u̯oi̯o:[** (with word-divider). For the latter, compare the dedicatory altar inscriptions CIL XII 4333 (11–13 A.D.) and CIL III 1933 (137 A.D.), both of which (despite their relative lateness and their geographical separation) preserve much the same archaic phraseology and structuration (see esp. Palmer *RRRE* ch. 2), including identical first-person formulations (*hanc aram dabo dedicaboque; ... hanc tibi aram ... do dico dedicoque*).

5. B (upper edge) **u̯o[.** Prosdocimi (203f. with facsimile) has shown that the upper edge of B contains at least the two letters **u̯o[**, oriented vertically above the second **u̯o** of B 1 **]:u̯oi̯o:?[**.[13]) In view of the difficulties with B 1 **]:u̯oi̯o:?[** (§ 4 above), these letters are surely of interest, although their interpretation remains uncertain. Prosdocimi tentatively suggests that this **u̯o[** was a preparatory sketch for the second **-u̯o** of B 1 **]:u̯oi̯o:?[**, intended to be scratched out later. But it is perhaps equally likely that this additional **u̯o[** (with normal V) was added as a corrected or modernized substitute for the original *initial* syllable **]:u̯o-** of B 1 **]:u̯oi̯o:?[**, because of the latter's unusual upside-down V. Alternatively, **u̯o[** may begin a short word (such as **u̯o[tom**) inadvertently omitted (perhaps haplologically, in view of B 1 **]:u̯oi̯o:?[**) from the original inscription; cf. the "sacral" figura etymologica *votum/vota voveo* (e.g. Plt. *Amph.* 947, Cato *Agr.*

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[11]) Note Leumann's interesting suggestion (*LLuF* 535) that CIL I² 560 **misc** (Praen.) may reflect *miscĕ* (not *miscē*), although this is far from certain; cf. Praen. **Orcvio, Orcvius** CIL I² 288, 231 etc. = *Orcēvius*, later *Orcīvius* (probably from an original **Orcei-*, see Wachter *AI* § 84b).

[12]) For **u̯eu̯e/o-* > **u̯ou̯e/o-* (*o* > *e* in initial syllable between labials), cf. perhaps *vomō* (vs. Gk. *ἐμέω*), whose *o*-vocalism is difficult to explain (despite Leumann *LLuF* 101) on purely morphological grounds – i.e., as resulting from an athematic formation (cf. Ved. *vámiti*). (For the replacement of a thematic **u̯eu̯ō* (or **u̯ou̯ō*) by an iterative *voveō*, compare, in the same semantic field, Lat. *spondeō* vs. Gk. *σπένδω*). The descriptive Schwebeablaut in **u̯eg^{u}h-e/o-* vs. (h_1)*eug*$^{(u)}$*h-e/o-* remains problematic, but cf. Ved. *vāghát-* vs. *óhate*.

[13]) The CIL annotation is unduly skeptical about the existence of these letters, and fails even to record Prosdocimi's reading of them. Wachter omits mention of them altogether.

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83, cf. *preces precor, venerem veneror,* U. *subocau suboco* (VI a 22) etc.; Ernout *Phil.* 2.109).

6. C 1 **]i̯—se** [?.[14]) Of the first letter, the lower half of a vertical stroke is visible, consistent in theory with I, T, F, P, R or (upside-down) L. But Prosdocimi persuasively argues in favor of I on the basis of the second character's traces, which allow for only two possibilities, namely a reversed S or an angled C: thus sequences TS/TC, FS/FC, etc., are for the most part excluded, while IS/IC are distinctly possible. As regards the choice between reversed S and angled C: a reversed S seems only remotely possible in view of the **-se** (with normal S) almost immediately following (despite B 1 **]:u̯ou̯o:**[?]**[,** with both reversed and normal V), and would not be expected, in any case, outside of a clear boustrophedon or serpentine context: angled C, in contrast, is perfectly acceptable paleographically. The most probable initial sequence, then, is **]i̯ç-** (and not **]i̯s-**). Since the traces of the third letter point either to A or upside-down V, we must therefore choose between restorations **]i̯[ça]se** or **]i̯[çu]se.** The latter yields nothing promising, even if a few forms like *augur, robur* etc. were originally *s*-stems. A form **]i̯[ça]se,** however, is immediately recognizable either as a present active infinitive, or a (so-called) "contracted" perfect (or "aorist") active infinitive, thus e.g. **(ded)]i̯[ça]se** = 'dedicare' or 'dedicasse' (or **(uind)]i̯[ça]se, (abd)]i̯[ça]se, (aidif)]i̯[ça]se,** etc.). In either case, the form would have considerable linguistic interest. An unrhotacized pres. infin. **-ase,** which is to be expected for this period (cf. Leumann *LLuF* 580), has so far remained unexampled, apart from the problematic gloss *dasi* "*dari*" (P.F. 60.9 L). If, on the other hand, **]i̯[ça]se** is perfect, it would antedate by several centuries the hitherto earliest-attested form (**coniourase** CIL I² 581.13, cf. **superases** CIL I² 10.5).[15])

Several paleographical consequences of this restoration are worth noting. For the C (one of the alphabetic gaps in the Satrican inscription): the angled C would be virtually identical (apart from the difference in orientation) to the (right-to-left) angled C of **Castorei** in the slightly earlier Castor-Pollux dedication (CIL I²(4) 2833; Lavi-

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[14]) See especially Prosdocimi's facsimiles, p. 205.

[15]) To the extent that one can base a decision on the preceding "context" (such as it is), the present infinitive seems the more likely possibility; in connection with B 1 **]:u̯ou̯o:**[, note the idiomatic use of *voveo* as a *verbum declarandi* followed by present infinitive with future meaning (Bennett *SEL* 1.372, 427, e.g. Plt. *Curc.* 72 *me inferre Veneri vovi iaientaculum*).

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nium, 6th c.) – one of the several letter-forms of this inscription labeled "noteworthy" by Gordon (*Lat. Epigr.* 76). The use of CA (and not "KA"), moreover, would document the (expected) loss of the older C/K spelling convention (see Wachter's discussion and table, *AI* § 39 d, with gaps, for this feature, for both the Lapis Satricanus and the Corcolle fragments). For the A: to judge from the trace, this must be either an A with ascending cross-stroke (A), an open A with ascending cross-stroke (A), or conceivably a closed A with angled cross-strokes (A); the same sort of formation is still clearer in the A of B 4 **]ioụeiại** (see Prosdocimi's facsimiles, pp. 203–4), as against the other A's, all with clear descending cross-stroke (A).[16]) Colonna's observation (*Lap. Satr.* 45) that the A's of the Corcolle fragments are all of the triangular type with descending cross-stroke, exactly as in the Lapis Satricanus, is therefore inaccurate. The Corcolle fragments in fact show a co-occurrence of both A and A (or A, or A),[17]) a new datum that calls for further study, together with the other paleographical features already mentioned in § **2.**

7. A 2 **iouos-**[+ B 2 **]-od:**. To begin with B 2 **]-od** (see Prosdocimi's facsimiles, pp. 203–4), the traces of the first character are difficult to interpret, since the lowermost diagonal stroke may be a chance abrasion. If not, it would most resemble **]ạod**, which seems morphologically impossible (unless one admits an error for **]ạ(t)od** – a methodologically difficult assumption, as Prosdocimi notes).[18]) If, on the other hand, the apparent diagonal is a chance abrasion, the most likely reading is **]ṃod**.

Since Prosdocimi, without explanation, sees no "syntactic justification" for a nominal **]mod** (e. g. **optu]mod**), he takes **]ṃod** to be an imperative, but of a hitherto unattested sort in Latin: it is a "middle imperative" in **-mōd* of the same type as U. *persnimu* 'pray'. But there are already two well-attested patterns for Archaic Latin deponent imperatives, i. e. (a) the type *-(n)tō* (*obsequitō, ūtuntō* etc.), and (b) the type (2/3 sg.) *-minō* (*antestāminō, praefāminō* etc.), of which the second is particularly charateristic of archaic legal and religious

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[16]) For the A of B 4 **]ioụeiại** (and perhaps **]i[ça]se[**), cf. the open A's with ascending cross-stroke (A) in the archaic (5th/4th c.) fragment CIL I² 361 reverse (facsimile in Wachter *AI* § 213).

[17]) Cf. Wachter's discussion of open vs. closed A's in the Praenestine bronzes, *AI* § 72 a.

[18]) Given the almost vertical stroke that is actually visible, we might also reckon with the possibility of a **]ṇod**, and perhaps also a **]ụod**, if the lowermost diagonal is real.

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language. Thus we need not gratuitously postulate an "Umbroid" middle imperative in *-mōd* (no matter how plausible an analogical scenario one can fashion to explain the creation of such a form in Latin), especially if **]ṇod** is paleographically possible (cf. n. 18), in which case we are free to set up an imperative **-mi]ṇod** – that is, if we judge an imperative to be desirable. In fact, consideration of A 2 **iouos-[** may suggest that Prosdocimi was hasty in rejecting a nominal interpretation like **optu]ṃod**.

The remaining bottom half of a vertical stroke in the last character of **iouos-[** is consistent with I, T, F, N, P, R, or (upside-down) L, but after "**iouos**" only I or T are probable. Prosdocimi favors **iouosṭ[**, citing the well-known form **iouestod** of the Forum Inscription (CIL I² 1); but he also admits the possibility of a gen. sg. **iouosi̯[o** 'Iovis' (cf. the probable nom. sg. **Iouos** CIL I² 563), or an abl. sg. **iouosi̯[d** 'iure'. Of these, a gen. sg. **iouosi̯[o** is most unlikely: despite Prosdocimi, **Diouos-[** would surely be expected for this period (cf. **Diouis** CIL I² 361, **Diuei** = [Di̯uu̯ei] 39, **Diouo** 60, **Diouem** 558), and the isolation of the Praenestine **Iouos** (even if, as seems probable, the form is nom. sg.)[19]) considerably weakens any support the form may provide for an early *o*-stem variant **Diovo-* beside consonant-stem **Diov-*. As for Prosdocimi's **iouosṭ[**: although an early form of the type *onustus, venustus* etc., is perhaps conceivable, the actually-attested form **iouestod** gives us no reason to expect a **iouosṭ[**, and thus renders an abl. **iouosi̯[d** the more likely restoration,[20]) despite the difficulty in explaining its second **-o-**.[21])

Now in a document of this sort, an abl. **iouosi̯[d** might well be used as part of a fixed expression. If we examine the evidence for fixed locutions with Lat. *iure,* especially those with a following con-

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[19]) For discussion see Wachter *AI* § 55 c.

[20]) An early consonant-stem abl. in **-īd** is, if anything, to be expected, given the frequency of this particular *i*-stem intrusion in second-century (and perhaps earlier) documents (e.g. CIL I² 366 **bovid**, 581 **coventionid**, 36 **[no]minid**, 364 **opid**) and the subsequent retreat of this feature (see esp. Blümel *Untersuch.* 67, Risch *CFS* 31 [1977] 239 = *Kl. Schr.* 609, Wachter *AI* § 122 d).

[21]) Beside the expected weak stem **ioues-** (CIL I² 1 **iouestod**, 4 **iouesat**), the sequence **iouos-** results either from an analogical extension of the nominative stem (typologically similar to the post-vowel-weakening type *tempus/temporis*), or from a phonetic assimilation ***iouesīd** > **iouosīd** (cf. **oppodum** CIL I² 585.81, **Modoratus** CIL VIII 10798 etc., Leumann *LLuF* 100, Sommer-Pfister *Hdbch.* 93); compare also *e...e...ī* (for **e...i...ī*) in *genetīvus, sepelīre* etc. (Leumann 84, Sommer-Pfister 84, 89).

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joined or agreeing ablative (which might be reflected in B 2 **]ṃod**),[22]) we find that, despite Prosdocimi's claim that (e.g.) **optu]mod** has no "syntactic justification", precisely the reverse is true: the fixed phrase *iure optimo* is in fact the *only* attested phraseological unit for *iure* plus adjective.[23]) Finally, note that the restoration A 2 + B 2 **iouosi̯[d:optu]ṃod**, if accepted, would provide evidence in favor of assuming that fragment A *directly* precedes fragment B, which was hitherto uncertain (cf. § 3 above), as well as a rough indication of the number of characters to be restored in the other lacunae between fragments A and B.[24])

8. B 2 **oṛaṭ[**. This form is assumed both by Prosdocimi and in CIL, probably correctly, to be based on *ōrāre* (e.g. imperative **oṛaṭ[od]**, or a form of *orator,* or perhaps of *oratio* in the sense 'actio sacra'). It may be worth noting, however, that the "dialectal" monophthongization ***au* > o** (attested relatively early, although inconsistently, in Pisaurum: CIL I² 379 **Pola** vs. 378 **Pisaurese**) is also found in Latium (e.g. CIL I² 483 **Lornti** [Rome], cf. also various *cippi Praenestini,* e.g. CIL I² 83 **Polia** vs. 2456 **Paula**).[25]) Indeed, a "rustic" ***oratus** (= *auratus*) is actually attested (in the form *orata*), although the word has no direct semantic bearing on the present document.[26])

If, however, **oṛaṭ[** is based on *ōrāre* (as seems most likely), the form would have several linguistic consequences. Since a rhotacized **-r-** is excluded for this period (see further § 9 below for more on rhotacism), **oṛaṭ[** would eliminate once and for all the traditional Roman etymology in terms of a denominative ***ōsā-*** based on *ōs* 'mouth' (Varro *LL* 6.76), still argued against explicitly, for example, in both Ernout-Meillet *DELL* and Walde-Hofmann *LEW.* Consequently, the idea that Osc. *urust* 'oraverit' (Ve 2.14, cf. also **urinss** 'orationes' Ve 3) is a borrowing from Latin (because of its *-r-*), which

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[22]) For such a sequence cf. CIL I² 1 **iouestod loiṷquiod**.

[23]) See *TLL* 7.699.30 ff. The legal (or at any rate technical) nuance of this phrase can be sensed from usages like *mihi consuli ... senatus iure optimo vim et manus intulisset* (Cic. *Cat.* 1.21), (*libertatem*) *iure optimo consecuti* (Papin. *Dig.* 4.4.31); with a "sacral" reference (but again in a legal context) e.g. CIL I² 594.I.4.36 (*pontifices auguresque*) *optima lege, optumo iure.*

[24]) Cf. Prosdocimi's tentative restoration A 3 + B 3 **fra[tro]m:muliar[es**, which would thus be several characters too short (not to speak of the improbable genitive phrase itself). Contra *Lornti*: O. Salomies, *Arctos* 22 (1988) 223.

[25]) See Leumann, *LLuF* 72, and more recently Wachter *AI* §§ 78 a, 99 a, 112 e, 216 i, 218 c.

[26]) Festus 196.26 L: *Orata genus piscis appellatur a colore auri, quod rustici orum dicebant, ut auriculas, oriculas.*

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was never compelling (cf. Ernout-Meillet), becomes entirely superfluous. Morphologically, *ōrāre* appears to continue a primary lengthened *ō*-grade "iterative-intensive" **ōrāi̯e/o-* (cf. Lat. *sōlor, cōnor*), although the prehistory of this formation in Latin, not to mention its relationship with possible comparanda elsewhere (cf. the Greek type *πωτάομαι*), remains unclear.

The etymological background of *ōrāre* is likewise murky, but can perhaps be somewhat clarified. Among the standard comparanda, Hitt. *ariya-* 'use divination' can probably be removed, since Kimball[27]) has argued persuasively in favor of connecting *ariya-* rather with Gk. *ἐρέω* 'inquire, interrogate' (but cf. n. 29); and the rare Ved. *áryati* (RV only 8.16.6, 10.48.3), traditionally said to mean 'praise', may be interpreted in other ways (see Mayrhofer *EWA* 172, s.v. *ĀR*), and is therefore not usable as evidence. If we provisionally eliminate also Gk. *ἀρνέομαι* 'deny' and Arm. *uranam* 'id'. on semantic grounds (although a root-connection is perhaps ultimately not excluded), we are left with Gk. *ἀράομαι* 'pray' (cf. Ion. *ἀρή* 'prayer', Arc. *καταρϝος* 'curse'), and perhaps Russ. *orát'* 'yell' (cf. SCr. *òriti se* 'resound').[28]) Insofar as IE alternations **a*(: **o*) : **ō* are rare to the point of non-existence, it is preferable to reconcile the stems "**ar-*" (Gk., Sl.) and "**ōr-*" (Lat., Osc.) via an *e*-grade **h₂er-* and a lengthened *ō*-grade **h₂ōr-*.[29])

9. B 3 **muliar[**. The **-r[**, whether word-final or intervocalic, presents an apparent conundrum: the adjective *muliebris* seems to show that the *-r-* of *mulier* reflects a rhotacized **-s-* (cf. *fūnus/fūnebris*);

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[27]) S. Kimball, "Hittite *ariya-*", in *Carter Festschrift* [in press].

[28]) Gamkrelidze and Ivanov *IJ* 802 f. arbitrarily distinguish between two roots "**arH-*" (*ἀράομαι*) and "**or-*" (*ōrāre*), which merely compounds the confusion. Moreover, their citation of U. (abl. pl.) **arves** with a gloss 'precibus' (as a cognate of Gk. *ἀράομαι*) may not be correct: U. **ar(u)via/arviu/** *aruio* (acc. pl.), **arves/arvis** (abl. pl.) may refer to an actual offering, although its precise nature is uncertain (traditionally 'exta', but perhaps rather grain-offerings, cf. U. **arvam(-en)** 'field', as discussed by Poultney *BT* ad I a 3, II a 18; cf. Meiser *Umbr.* 193 ff.).

[29]) Other theoretically possible methods of accounting for Lat./Osc. *ōr-* (e.g. *o*-grade **(H)oHr-*, *e*-grade **(H)eh₃r-*, etc.) have as yet no particular etymological justification; a perf. **h₂e-h₂or-* > **h₂o-h₂or-* could perhaps be supported morphologically if Pisani's (*Gramm.* 230) perfect-based explanation for the vocalism of the type *sēdāre* (: *sēdī*, cf. *sōlor* if < **sōdāi̯e/o-*) is correct, although more recently he takes *sōlor* as ultimately denominative (*IF* 88 [1983] 96). If, finally, the original meaning of *ōrāre* is judged to be closer to Hitt. *ariya-* and Gk. *ἐρέω* than to Gk. *ἀράομαι* etc. (see esp. Benveniste, *RPhil.* 22 [1948] 120–2 = Strunk *Probleme* 162–4 on *ōrāculum*), then we would have an *ō*-grade **h₁ōr-*.

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but rhotacism cannot have taken place by the time of **muliar[** (cf. **Valesiosio** in the Lapis Satricanus, and perhaps **]i̯[ca̯]se,** §6 above).[30])

Neither do the **-u-** nor the **-a-** square well with the standard etymology in terms of a **mḷ̥-i̯es-ih₂*, thought to be related to comparative formations like *melior* (cf. Leumann *LLuF* 58, 497).[31]) Thus it may be advisable to revive, with Prosdocimi, the connection of *mulier* with some marginal Greek vocabulary ultimately related to **mel(h₁)-* 'grind',[32]) e.g. *μύλλω βινέω'* (Theoc.), Sicil. *μυλλοί* 'pudenda muliebria'. Morphologically, Prosdocimi interprets **muliar[** in terms of a stem **muliăr(i)-* (beside a parallel *s*-stem in *mulier/muliebris*), invoking *procus* : *procĕrēs* (allegedly < **proc-ări-*) and *lūcus* : *Lūcĕrēs* (to which Prosdocimi compares CIL I² 401 **loucarid** [Luceria, 3rd/2nd c.], cf. CIL I² 1730 **[l]ucar**). But even if these paired items are in both cases etymologically related to each other (which is not at all certain), the comparison with **loucarid** is specious: the form is attested too late[33]) to contain a short **-ă-** unaffected by medial vowel-weakening, and therefore must reflect **loucārid**; thus it may be preferable to assume rather a "non-Latin" stem **muliār[** of the type **loucār-**: that is, **mulio-* [Gk. *μυλλο-*] : **muli-ār-*, like *lūcus* : **loucār-**, and perhaps also *cānus* : Osc./Pael. *casnar* 'senex'. But the derivational relationship between this *r*-stem and the Lat. *s*-stem *mulier/muliebris* remains unclear.

10. C2 **]os:[mu̯]li[.**[34]) Prosdocimi takes **]os** as a genitive singular (of the type **senatuos, Cererus, nationu** etc.; Leumann *LLuF* 435)

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[30]) Wachter (*AI* §37a, n.234) hypothesizes that the traditional date for the adoption of rhotacized spellings (second half of the fourth century) might postdate the rhotacism process itself by about a century, implying that **muliar[** may actually reflect a rhotacized form, with an unusually early rhotacized spelling. While this scenario is "not impossible" (to borrow Wachter's phrase), the burden of proof rests on the "precocious rhotacists", especially in view of the official nature of this document.

[31]) Wachter points out that an original stem **muliăr-* will also yield Lat. *mulier-*; note that this would deprive the form of a morphological analysis via comparative **-i̯es-* (cf. also the traditional Roman interpretation *mulier* < "*mollior*"), which was problematic in any case.

[32]) Similarly Gamkrelidze and Ivanov *IJ* 693, with discussion of cultural implications.

[33]) The traditional late-fourth-century dating may well be too old by a century or more (see Wachter *AI* §196b).

[34]) Wachter transcribes conservatively **]os:[- -]li[**, but Prosdocimi (followed in CIL) convincingly restores **]os:[mu̯]li[** on the basis of the traces (and comparing B3 **]m:muliar[**).

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depending on **[mụ]li[** ("la 'mulier' di un []*os*"; similarly A 3 **]os** and A 4 **]os**, see §§ **11** and **12**); but this is far from certain. A nominative singular may be supported on the basis of an important text not previously cited in connection with the Corcolle fragments, namely the sacral prohibition partly involving *mulieres* recorded by Festus s. v. *exesto* (the unique attestation of "*exsum*"): *Exesto, extra esto. Sic enim lictor in quibusdam sacris clamitabat: "hostis,* ***vinctus, mulier,*** *virgo exesto"; scilicet interesse prohibebatur.* (P. F. 72. 10 L; see § **11** below for another sacral prohibition). In theory, then, one might just as easily conjecture a sequence like **(uinct)]os:[mụ]li[**, or even (taking A 2 + B 2 + C 2 as part of the same sequence, cf. § 7 end) roughly (e. g. **flamen**[35]) **iouosị[d optu]mod oṛaṭ[od: "hostis, uinct]os, mụli[ar** ...".[36])

11. A 4 **]os:uid[.** According to Prosdocimi, we have here a phrase "*vid*[*ua*] di qualcuno", with **]os** again a consonant-stem genitive singular, more specifically "genitivo della persona (giuridica) di cui la *vid*[*ua*] *ne*[ ]*tod*" (208). But this is unlikely. Early Lat. *vidua* 'widowed/divorced/separated woman' is generally used as an absolute designation of status, without further specification; similarly Skt. *vidhávā-*, ORuss. *vьdova* etc., perhaps reflecting IE usage.[37]) Thus if **uid[** = *vidua,* **]os** is more likely nom. sg., e. g. in a series (A 4 + B 4 + C 4) **[..., X-]os, uid[ua ...] ne[-n]tod.** Note further that **uid[** almost certainly cannot be masculine (thus e. g. **X-]os:uid[uos**), since *viduus* (both 'widower' and adj.) appears only after Plautus (with the pointed exception of *Merc.* 829 *plures viri sint vidui quam nunc mulieres,* clearly based on *vidua*), and probably developed relatively late within Latin.[38]) Since, moreover, *viduus* adj. is generally construed

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[35]) E. g. **flamen** (not **lictor**), since the trace of the first character of A 2 (i. e. the last letter of the word directly preceding **iouoị[d**) is a diagonal stroke consistent with **u, n** or (less likely) a five-stroke **m**.

[36]) Similarly, in view of Prosdocimi's attractive suggestion (211) **a[b/f]ḷo[ucod** (or **ḷo[cod**) for C 3, one could conjecture, for B 3 + C 3, e. g. **muliar[:exesto]d:a[b/f]ḷo[ucod**. But it should also be noted, in passing, that *mulieres* might have been mentioned for purposes of *inclusion,* and not just exclusion: cf., for example, the entry *Mutini Titini sacellum Romae fuit. Cui mulieres velatae togis praetextatis solebant sacrificare* (P. F. 143. 10 L), discussed by Palmer *RRRE* 195 f.; on the divinity and his rites see now also Radke *Gottesvorstellung* 221, 270.

[37]) Typically e. g. RV 10. 40. 2cd *kó vām śayutrā́ vidháveva deváram / ... kṛṇute* "Who takes you to bed, as the widow [takes] her brother-in-law?"

[38]) This last point would render unlikely a reference to the divinity *Viduus* (*"qui animam corpore viduet",* Tert. *Nat.* 2. 15. 2; cf. Radke *Götter* 337 f.).

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with the ablative (genitive only Ovid+), a phrase **]os** (gen.) + **uid[ua/-os** 'deprived of/bereft of X' (vel sim.) is excluded.

But it is unnecessary to operate exclusively with *vidua* or *viduus,* since **uid[** may well be a form of *video.* Among the few recorded sacral prohibitions concerning women (cf. §10), the one mentioned by Cato in the context of a vow (*Agr.* 83, "*votum pro bubus*") specifies precisely: ***Mulier** ad eam rem divinam ne adsit neve **videat.***[39])

12. A3 **]os:fra[.** Prosdocimi takes **]os:** once more as genitive singular (cf. §§10 and 11), and **fra[** is "definitely" a form of *frater,* perhaps in a usage like Lat. *fratres Arvales* 'Arval (religious) brethren'. This may well be correct; but in a document with legal or quasi-legal overtones (cf. B4 + C4 **ne[ ]ṭod**), it may not be wise to exclude the possibility that **fra[** is rather **fra[us/d-**; indeed, apart from the divinity *Fraus* (e.g. Cic. *ND* 3.17.44, although not listed in Radke *Götter*), a series of actually-attested phraseological patterns with *fraus* and *fraudāre,* some demonstrably traditional, can account directly for a sequence **]os:fra[**, and in no case is **]os:** to be taken as genitive:

(a) A traditional collocation of *scelus* and *fraus* can be justified on the basis of the correlated phrases *ne fraus esto, ... ne populo scelus esto* in the ancient *ver sacrum* formula (Liv. 22.10.5), together with collocations like *scelus fraudemque* (Cic. *De Or.* 1.46.202), *fraudis, sceleris, parricidi, peiiuri plenissumus* (Plt. *Rud.* 651), hence in theory **scel]os:fra[usque** (or **fra[udemque**).

(b) For a conditional clause like **sei X-]os:fra[udem fac-**, cf. XII Tab. 8,21 *Patronus si clienti fraudem faxit, sacer esto,* CIL I² 590.30 ... *quo hoic legi fraudem f(aceret),* etc.

(c) If **fra[** is a form of *fraudāre,* a masc. acc. pl. direct object (i.e. **]ōs:fra[udā-**) would be syntactically trivial (Cic. passim etc.), while a preceding nom. sg. (i.e. **]ŏs:fra[udā-**) might belong with a formulaic expression like *uti ne ... captus fraudatusve siem* (Cic. *Off.* 3.17.70).

(d) Given the evidence for an archaic deponent *frausus est,*[40]) one could imagine a participial phrase **fraus]os:fra[udem,** with deponent participle, referring to someone 'having committed an act of deception'.

While none of these possibilities is necessarily correct, together

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[39]) For sacral prohibitions concerning women and others, see in general Appel *Prec.* 82f. and Norden *AP* 263 (with Greek parallels).

[40]) Cf. *metuo ... ne quam fraudem frausu' sit* (Plt. *As.* 286), *frausus erit: fraudem commiserit* (P.F. 81.2L).

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they indicate that Prosdocimi's certitude about *frater* or *fratres* is inappropriate.

13. B 4 **]ioṇeiại:.** Given the presumed nature of the document, together with the apparent prohibition B 4 + C 4 **ne[ ]ṭod** directly following **]ioṇeiại:** (cf. § 3 above), Prosdocimi surmises that someone is here being asked not to do something "at (or to) the altar of Jupiter". Comparing further U. *asa deueia* (VI a 9, 10), he therefore restores **[asai:d]ioṇeiại:**, which he regards as "certain". But note first that the Umbrian phrase is not analogous, since it means 'ara divina/ Ara Divina', not 'ara Iovia'. Secondly, for an expression like "the altar of Jupiter", the adjectival usage is unexpected (as opposed to an adnominal genitive **"asai Diovis"**, cf. *Iovis aram* Enn. scen. 93 V³, *aram Iunonis* (§ 3 above), **ara Salutus** CIL I² 62 etc.; see also Wachter *AI* § 86 j). Indeed, the adjective *Iovius* is virtually unattested in Latin until quite late,[41]) although well-attested elsewhere in Italic. Most germane is the "patronymic" usage (cf. Leumann *LLuF* 288), attested for both male and female divinities, as in Osc. *Διωϝιας Διομανα[ς]* (Pocc 168) etc., U. *Tursa Iouia* etc., Pael. *Iouiois puclois* (Ve 202), Marruc. *Tarincris Iouias* (Ve 218.7), *Cerie Iouia* (Ve 218.10), and dialectal Lat. (**[I]ouies pucle[s]** [Ve 244 + Pocc 222], **Herclo Iouio** [CIL I² 394 = Ve 220]), cf. Lat. **Venerus Iouiae** (CIL I² 675, 676; Capua, 108 B.C.). Thus, if Prosdocimi's interpretation of the form is correct, what is most striking about **d]ioṇeiại:** (whether one assumes **[asai]** or a female divinity, cf. **Venerus Iouiae** etc.) is precisely its "non-Latin" character (in this respect cf. § 8 **oṛaṭ[** for ***auṛat[** (??, cf. Lat. *orata* etc.), § 9 **muliār[** (?, cf. *loucār-*, Osc./Pael. *casnar*)), in terms of syntax and phraseology.[42])

To borrow Meillet's ubiquitous phrase (in *DELL*): "Tout est en l'air", I have tried, nevertheless, to point out a number of interesting possibilities and pertinent textual parallels that deserve to be noted in connection with this fascinating, if frustrating, document.[43])

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[41]) For discussion and references see Radke *Gottesvorstellung* 239 f. with n. 397.

[42]) Also worth noting is Osc. **diuvia[is]** 'Ioviis (feriis)' (Ve 76 a, b), **iụ́viaṣs** 'Iovias (ferias)' (Ve 86), although this usage is restricted to the plural (cf. Lat. *feriae*).

[43]) An earlier version of this paper was presented at the Ninth East Coast Indo-European Conference (University of Pennsylvania; June, 1990). I am grateful to the participants of the conference for their helpful comments.

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Korrekturnachtrag

The present article was written during 1989–1990, without knowledge of A. Morandi's important contribution, "L'ara inscritta di Corcolle. Aspetti monumentali ed epigrafici", *Revue belge de philologie et d'histoire* 65.1 (1987) 97–112, which became available to me only during proofreading. Although I disagree with some of Morandi's findings, I am happy to report the independent convergence of our restorations of the interesting new verb form C 1 **]i[ca]se** (§ 6 above) and **]xicase** (Morandi, pp. 108 f., 111). Further discussion occasioned by Morandi's treatment will be found in my forthcoming monograph, *Studies in Archaic Latin Inscriptions.*

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